GB3 GYM PLAN

4-Day Split

Chest · Legs · Back · Shoulders. One focus per day: 4 exercises plus 1 bonus, with a cable setup for every cable exercise.

Your week

MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
Day 1 **Chest + Triceps**	Day 2 **Legs**	Rest walk if you like	Day 3 **Back + Biceps**	Rest walk if you like	Day 4 **Shoulders**	Rest walk if you like

Other days work too. Keep the order (Day 1, 2, 3, 4) and never do Chest and Shoulders on back-to-back days, because both use your front shoulders and triceps.

The plan at a glance

1 Chest + Triceps

1	Incline dumbbell press	3 × 8–12
2	Machine chest press	3 × 10–12
3	Low-to-high cable fly	3 × 12–15
4	Triceps rope pushdown	3 × 12–15
5	Plank BONUS	3 × 20–40 s

+ Stationary bike, 20 min

2 Legs

1	Leg press	4 × 10–15
2	Seated leg curl	3 × 12–15
3	Leg extension	3 × 12–15
4	Back extension (45° bench)	3 × 12–15
5	Seated calf raise BONUS	3 × 15

+ Elliptical, 20 min

3 Back + Biceps

1	Lat pulldown	3 × 10–12
2	Seated cable row	3 × 10–12
3	Machine row (chest pad)	3 × 10–12
4	Cable curl	3 × 10–12
5	Rope hammer curl BONUS	3 × 12

+ Bike or elliptical, 25 min

4 Shoulders

1	Seated dumbbell shoulder press	3 × 8–12
2	Dumbbell lateral raise	3 × 12–15
3	Face pull	3 × 15
4	Single-arm cable lateral raise	3 × 12–15
5	Overhead cable triceps extension BONUS	3 × 12–15

+ Elliptical or bike, 30 min

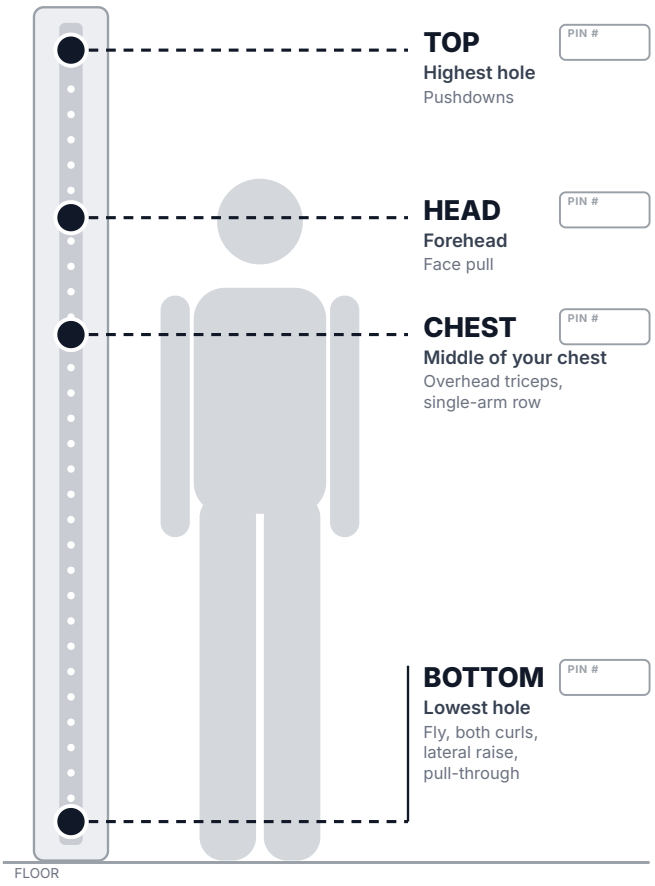
How to train

1. **Warm up (5 min).** Easy bike or elliptical, then 2 light sets of exercise 1: about half your weight × 12, then three-quarters × 6. These don't count as work sets.
2. **How heavy?** Pick a weight where you finish each set with about 2 good reps left in you. The last 2–3 reps should feel hard, but your form stays clean.
3. **When to go up.** Once you hit the top of the rep range on every set (e.g. 3 × 12 on 8–12), add weight next time: +5 lb dumbbells and upper-body machines, +10 lb leg press, +1 plate on cables. Then build the reps back up.
4. **Rest.** 2 min after exercise 1 (the heavy one). 60–90 s for everything else.
5. **Speed.** Lift in about 1 s, lower in 2–3 s. No swinging or bouncing.
6. **Low-energy day.** Do exercises 1–3 only and skip the rest. That still counts as a full session. Showing up beats skipping.
7. **Bonus (5).** Only if you still have energy after exercise 4.
8. **Easy week.** Every 6th week, keep the same weights but do 2 sets instead of 3. You'll come back stronger.
9. **Pain rule.** Sharp or joint pain means stop that exercise and use its swap. Muscle burn is fine.
10. **Cardio finisher.** After the weights. Tired? 10 min is fine. Bikes taken? Walk on an incline treadmill: 3.0–3.5 mph at 5–8% incline.

CABLE SETUP GUIDE

Where to set the pulley

Every cable machine numbers its holes differently, so this plan uses your body as the ruler. Find each height once, write the hole number in the box, and next time setup takes two seconds.



Set up any cable in 4 steps

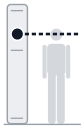
1. **Height.** Pull the pop-pin on the column, slide the pulley to the landmark, let go, and tug it to check it clicked in.
2. **Attachment.** Clip the handle onto the carabiner and make sure the gate snaps fully shut.
3. **Weight.** Put the pin in the stack. Start lighter than you think; cables feel heavier than dumbbells.
4. **Step out.** Move away until the plates lift just off the stack at the start. They shouldn't touch down between reps.

The handles



Numbers don't transfer. A "30" on one cable tower can feel like 20 on another, because the pulleys differ. Use the same machine when you can and log which one.

Fixed stations. The lat pulldown and the seated row have pulleys that don't move. Set the seat, thigh pad and foot plate instead.



Height (side view): the dot is the pulley; the dashed line shows where it hits your body.



Where you stand (seen from above): the dark bar is the machine; the arrow is the way you face.

Every cable exercise in the plan

EXERCISE	DAY	PULLEY	ATTACHMENT	WHERE YOU STAND
Low-to-high cable fly	**1 · Chest + Tri**	**BOTTOM (both)**	2 D-handles	Center, 1 step forward, staggered
Triceps rope pushdown	**1 · Chest + Tri**	**TOP**	Rope	Facing, ½ step back
Straight-bar pushdown SWAP	**1 · Chest + Tri**	**TOP**	Straight bar	Facing, ½ step back
Cable pull-through SWAP	**2 · Legs**	**BOTTOM**	Rope	Facing away, straddle cable, 2–3 steps out
Lat pulldown	**3 · Back + Bi**	**Fixed (top)**	Wide bar	Seated, thighs under the pad
Seated cable row	**3 · Back + Bi**	**Fixed (low)**	V-handle	Seated, feet on the plate
Single-arm cable row SWAP	**3 · Back + Bi**	**CHEST**	D-handle	Facing, staggered feet
Cable curl	**3 · Back + Bi**	**BOTTOM**	Straight / EZ bar	Facing, 1 ft back
Rope hammer curl	**3 · Back + Bi**	**BOTTOM**	Rope	Facing, 1 ft back
Face pull	**4 · Shoulders**	**HEAD**	Rope	Facing, 2 steps back
Single-arm cable lateral raise	**4 · Shoulders**	**BOTTOM**	D-handle	Side-on, far hand, 1 step away
Overhead cable triceps extension	**4 · Shoulders**	**CHEST**	Rope	Facing away, 1 big step out

DAY 1 · SUGGESTED MONDAY

1 Chest + Triceps

Heavy upper-chest press first, while you're fresh. Just one triceps exercise: every press already works them.

DATES

Wk 1 _____ Wk 2 _____

Wk 3 _____ Wk 4 _____

Warm-up: 5 min easy bike or elliptical + 2 light sets of #1 (half weight × 12, three-quarters × 6)

LOG: WEIGHT, REPS PER SET (40: 12, 11, 10)

1 Incline dumbbell press

پرس بالا سینه دمبل

3 × 8–12 rest 2 min HEAVY LIFT

SETUP Bench at about 30° (a low incline, not 45°). Kick the dumbbells up off your thighs.

HOW Lower to your upper chest, elbows about 45° from your body (not flared). Press up and slightly in. **Your 40 lb lift: at 3 × 12, go up 5 lb.**

TAKEN? Incline machine press (handles start at upper-chest height).

WK 1 | WK 2 | WK 3 | WK 4

2 Machine chest press

پرس سینه دستگاه

3 × 10–12 rest 90 s

SETUP Seat height so the handles line up with the middle of your chest.

HOW Shoulder blades back against the pad. Press out without slamming your elbows straight; take 2–3 s on the way back.

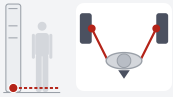
TAKEN? Flat dumbbell bench press.

WK 1 | WK 2 | WK 3 | WK 4

3 Low-to-high cable fly

کراس اوور از پایین به بالا

3 × 12–15 rest 60–90 s



CABLE SETUP

Pulley **BOTTOM, both columns**

Handle 2 single D-handles

Stand Center of the station, 1 step forward, staggered feet

MY PIN # _____

HOW Hands start low by your hips, palms forward, elbows slightly bent. Sweep up and in until your hands meet at chin height. **Start light: 10–15 lb a side.**

TAKEN? Pec deck (handles at chest height). Only one column free? Do one arm at a time.

WK 1 | WK 2 | WK 3 | WK 4

4 Triceps rope pushdown

پشت بازو طناب

3 × 12–15 rest 60 s



CABLE SETUP

Pulley **TOP, highest hole**

Handle Rope

Stand Facing the machine, half a step back, slight forward lean

MY PIN # _____

HOW Elbows pinned to your sides. Push down until your arms are straight, spreading the rope ends apart. Elbows don't move. **Weaker after pressing is normal.**

TAKEN? Straight-bar pushdown (same setup, straight bar, palms down).

WK 1 | WK 2 | WK 3 | WK 4

5 Plank

پلانک

3 × 20–40 s rest 45 s BONUS: ONLY IF YOU HAVE ENERGY

HOW Forearms under your shoulders, body in one straight line, glutes squeezed. Knees down if your lower back sags.

TAKEN? Dead bug, 3 × 8 slow reps per side.

WK 1 | WK 2 | WK 3 | WK 4

FINISH **Stationary bike**: 20 min, moderate (you can talk in short sentences). Bikes taken? Walk on an incline treadmill: 3.0–3.5 mph at 5–8% incline.

NOTES: SEAT SETTINGS, WHAT FELT GOOD, WHAT HURT

DAY 2 · SUGGESTED TUESDAY

2 Legs

Machines only, joint-friendly. The leg press is the big one; everything after it is lighter.

DATES

Wk 1 _____ Wk 2 _____

Wk 3 _____ Wk 4 _____

Warm-up: 5 min easy bike or elliptical + 2 light sets of #1 (half weight × 12, three-quarters × 6)

LOG: WEIGHT, REPS PER SET (40: 12, 11, 10)

1 Leg press — پرس پا دستگاه

4 × 10–15 rest 2 min HEAVY LIFT

SETUP Feet shoulder-width in the middle of the platform.

HOW Lower until your knees are at about 90° while your lower back stays on the pad. Push through your whole foot; don't lock your knees.

TAKEN? Smith machine squat, or goblet squat to a box.

WK 1 | WK 2 | WK 3 | WK 4

2 Seated leg curl — پشت پا ماشین

3 × 12–15 rest 90 s

SETUP Knees in line with the pivot dot. Thigh pad snug, ankle pad just above your heels.

HOW Curl all the way back, squeeze for 1 s, then lower slowly for 3 s.

TAKEN? Lying leg curl.

WK 1 | WK 2 | WK 3 | WK 4

3 Leg extension — جلو پا ماشین

3 × 12–15 rest 60–90 s

SETUP Knees in line with the pivot dot, ankle pad on your lower shin, back flat on the seat.

HOW Straighten your legs fully, squeeze for 1 s, lower slowly. Hold the side handles.

TAKEN? Leg press with your feet low and narrow on the platform.

WK 1 | WK 2 | WK 3 | WK 4

4 Back extension (45° bench) — فیله کمر

3 × 12–15 rest 60–90 s

SETUP Top of the pad just below your hip bones, so you bend at the hips.

HOW Arms crossed on your chest. Lower until your hamstrings stretch, then rise until your body is straight, not past it. Squeeze your glutes at the top.

TAKEN? Cable pull-through: BOTTOM pulley, rope, face away, straddle the cable, 2–3 steps out.

WK 1 | WK 2 | WK 3 | WK 4

5 Seated calf raise — ساق پا نشسته

3 × 15 rest 60 s BONUS: ONLY IF YOU HAVE ENERGY

SETUP Pad snug on your lower thighs, balls of your feet on the edge of the step.

HOW All the way down (1 s stretch), all the way up (1 s squeeze).

TAKEN? Calf raises on the leg press.

WK 1 | WK 2 | WK 3 | WK 4

FINISH **Elliptical**: 20 min, easy to moderate. Bikes taken? Walk on an incline treadmill: 3.0–3.5 mph at 5–8% incline.

NOTES: SEAT SETTINGS, WHAT FELT GOOD, WHAT HURT

DAY 3 · SUGGESTED THURSDAY

3 Back + Biceps

Pull with your elbows, not your hands. Both curls use the same low pulley, so you only switch the handle.

DATES

Wk 1 _____ Wk 2 _____

Wk 3 _____ Wk 4 _____

Warm-up: 5 min easy bike or elliptical + 2 light sets of #1 (half weight × 12, three-quarters × 6)

LOG: WEIGHT, REPS PER SET (40: 12, 11, 10)

1 Lat pulldown — زیر بغل سیم‌کش

3 × 10–12 rest 2 min **HEAVY LIFT**



CABLE STATION

Pulley **Fixed at the top (nothing to set)**
Handle Long wide bar
Stand Seated, thighs locked under the pad (set the pad first)

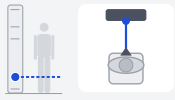
HOW Hands a bit wider than your shoulders. Lean back slightly and pull the bar to your upper chest, elbows down to your ribs. Arms straight at the top.

TAKEN? Assisted pull-up machine.

WK 1 | WK 2 | WK 3 | WK 4

2 Seated cable row — زیر بغل قایقی

3 × 10–12 rest 90 s



CABLE STATION

Pulley **Fixed low pulley (row station)**
Handle V-handle (close grip)
Stand Seated, feet on the foot plate, knees slightly bent

HOW Sit tall, chest up. Pull the handle to your belly button and squeeze your shoulder blades. Arms reach forward without rounding your back.

TAKEN? Single-arm cable row (CHEST-height pulley, D-handle, staggered feet).

WK 1 | WK 2 | WK 3 | WK 4

3 Machine row (chest pad) — زیر بغل قایقی دستگاه

3 × 10–12 rest 90 s

SETUP Handles at mid-chest height; chest pad set so you reach them with straight arms.

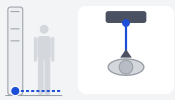
HOW Chest stays on the pad. Pull your elbows back past your ribs, squeeze for 1 s, return slowly. **Replaces the one-arm dumbbell row.**

TAKEN? Chest-supported dumbbell row (face-down on a 30–45° bench).

WK 1 | WK 2 | WK 3 | WK 4

4 Cable curl — جلو بازو سیم‌کش

3 × 10–12 rest 60–90 s



CABLE SETUP

Pulley **BOTTOM, lowest hole** MY PIN # _____
Handle Straight bar (or EZ bar)
Stand Facing the machine, about 1 foot back, feet hip-width

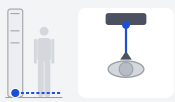
HOW Elbows stay glued to your sides. Curl to shoulder height, then lower slowly for 3 s. Don't lean back to help.

TAKEN? EZ-bar curl.

WK 1 | WK 2 | WK 3 | WK 4

5 Rope hammer curl — جلو بازو چکشی طناب

3 × 12 rest 60 s BONUS: ONLY IF YOU HAVE ENERGY



CABLE SETUP

Pulley **BOTTOM, same as #4** MY PIN # _____
Handle Rope (unclip the bar, clip on the rope)
Stand Same spot as #4

HOW Palms face each other the whole time. Curl up, squeeze, lower slowly.

TAKEN? Dumbbell hammer curl.

WK 1 | WK 2 | WK 3 | WK 4

FINISH **Bike or elliptical:** 25 min, moderate. Bikes taken? Walk on an incline treadmill: 3.0–3.5 mph at 5–8% incline.

DAY 4 · SUGGESTED SATURDAY

4 Shoulders

Side delts (lateral raises) make shoulders look wider. They recover fast, so they get two exercises. Light weights, strict form.

DATES

Wk 1 _____ Wk 2 _____

Wk 3 _____ Wk 4 _____

Warm-up: 5 min easy bike or elliptical + 2 light sets of #1 (half weight × 12, three-quarters × 6)

LOG: WEIGHT, REPS PER SET (40: 12, 11, 10)

1 Seated dumbbell shoulder press

پرس سرشانه دمبل

3 × 8–12 rest 2 min HEAVY LIFT

SETUP Bench upright, one notch back from vertical. Dumbbells start at chin level.

HOW Press up until your arms are straight (not locked), dumbbells slightly in front of your head. Lower to chin level; back stays on the pad.

TAKEN? Machine shoulder press (handles start at shoulder height).

WK 1 | WK 2 | WK 3 | WK 4

2 Dumbbell lateral raise

نشر جانب دمبل

3 × 12–15 rest 60–90 s

SETUP Standing, feet hip-width, slight forward lean, light dumbbells.

HOW Raise your arms out to the sides up to shoulder height, elbows slightly bent, leading with your elbows. Lower slowly for 3 s.

TAKEN? Lateral raise machine.

WK 1 | WK 2 | WK 3 | WK 4

3 Face pull

فیس پول طناب

3 × 15 rest 60 s



CABLE SETUP

Pulley **HEAD, forehead height** MY PIN # _____

Handle Rope

Stand Facing the machine, 2 steps back, arms straight

HOW Thumbs pointing back toward you. Pull to your forehead with elbows high and wide, spreading the rope ends past your ears. Squeeze 1 s.

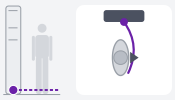
TAKEN? Reverse pec deck (rear-delt machine).

WK 1 | WK 2 | WK 3 | WK 4

4 Single-arm cable lateral raise

نشر جانب سیم‌کش تک‌دست

3 × 12–15 each arm rest 60 s after both arms



CABLE SETUP

Pulley **BOTTOM, lowest hole** MY PIN # _____

Handle 1 D-handle

Stand Side-on, 1 small step away, handle in the far hand

HOW The cable crosses in front of your body. Raise your arm out to the side up to shoulder height, elbow slightly bent; lower for 3 s. **Lighter than dumbbells.**

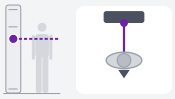
TAKEN? Seated dumbbell lateral raise.

WK 1 | WK 2 | WK 3 | WK 4

5 Overhead cable triceps extension

پشت بازو طناب از پشت سر

3 × 12–15 rest 60 s BONUS: ONLY IF YOU HAVE ENERGY



CABLE SETUP

Pulley **CHEST, mid-chest height** MY PIN # _____

Handle Rope

Stand Facing away, 1 big step forward, staggered feet, slight lean

HOW Elbows by your ears, hands behind your head. Straighten your arms forward and up, then come back slowly for a deep stretch. **Your 2nd triceps exercise of the week.**

TAKEN? Seated overhead dumbbell extension.

WK 1 | WK 2 | WK 3 | WK 4

FINISH **Elliptical or bike:** 30 min, moderate (shortest weight day, so the longest cardio). Bikes taken? Walk on an incline treadmill: 3.0–3.5 mph at 5–8% incline.